Form No. 723

Lesotho Meteorological Services
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Period 01st to 10th December 2025	**Season: 2025/2026**
Issued on 12th December 2025	**Bulletin No.5/5**

Ten-Day Agrometeorological Bulletin

…dedicated to the agricultural community.

… aimed at harmonizing agricultural activities with weather and climate.

Highlights

Hailstorms cause massive destruction.

Rainfall worst performance.

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Rainfall review (01-10 December 2025)

Rainfall Performance

Devastating and destructive hailstorms wreaked havoc as farmers suffered significant loss of livestock (mostly sheep) on the 23rd November 2025. Areas most affected were reported to be within Maletsunyane constituency where multiple villages were involved. On the contrary, the first dekad of December shows a significant decline in rainfall performance. Fig. 1 below displays the worst performer as Thaba-tseka which recorded less than 10mm of rain, followed by Quthing in the south, then finally Botha-Bothe in the north. However, Mafeteng, Mohale's Hoek and Qacha's Nek along the Senqu River Valley (SRV) performed slightly better with rainfall near normal or slightly above normal. Rain days ranged from 2 to 5.

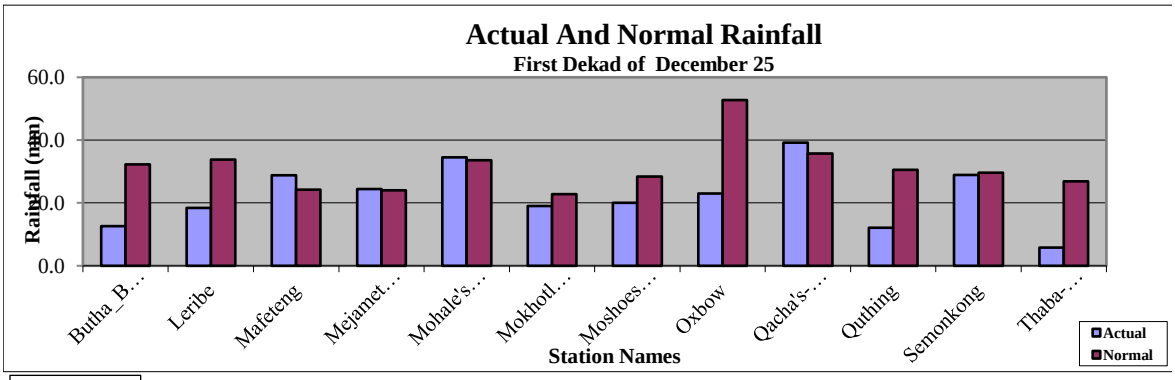

Fig. 1

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Fig. 2 below confirms the decreased rainfall for Dekad_1 (Dekad_34 on the graph) of December across the country. Take note of very low rainfall amounts experienced at the same period in 2024-25. The records are much lower than the historical (climate) records or baseline of 1981-2010.

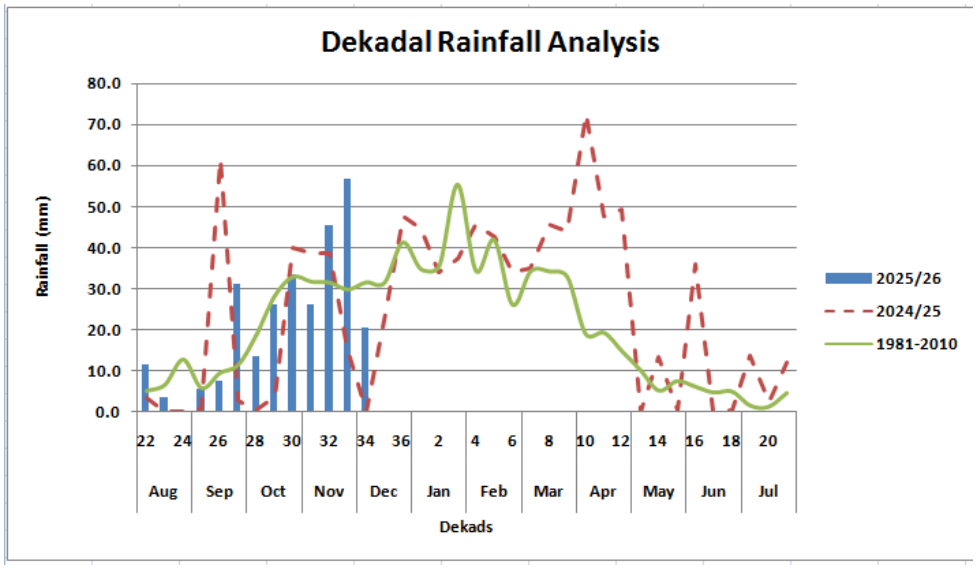

Fig. 2

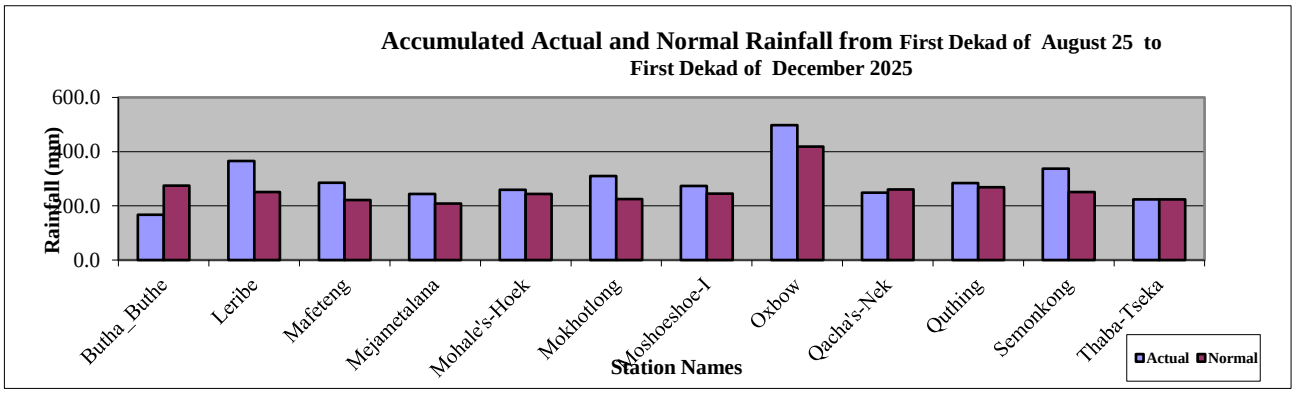

Fig.3

Fig.3 above suggests that overall rainfall performance since the start of the rainfall season in August 2025 has been satisfactory except in Botha-Bothe at -39% departure which is below normal. Leribe departure from normal is 46%, Mokhotlong 38%, Semonkong 35% and Mafeteng at 29% are above normal. The rest of the other stations are within the normal rainfall range.

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Vegetation Condition Index (NDVI Anomaly)

Fig. 4 below illustrates the state of the health of vegetation for Dekad 1 December. It shows the current vegetation being greener than normal with improvement in rainfall relative to long term normal.

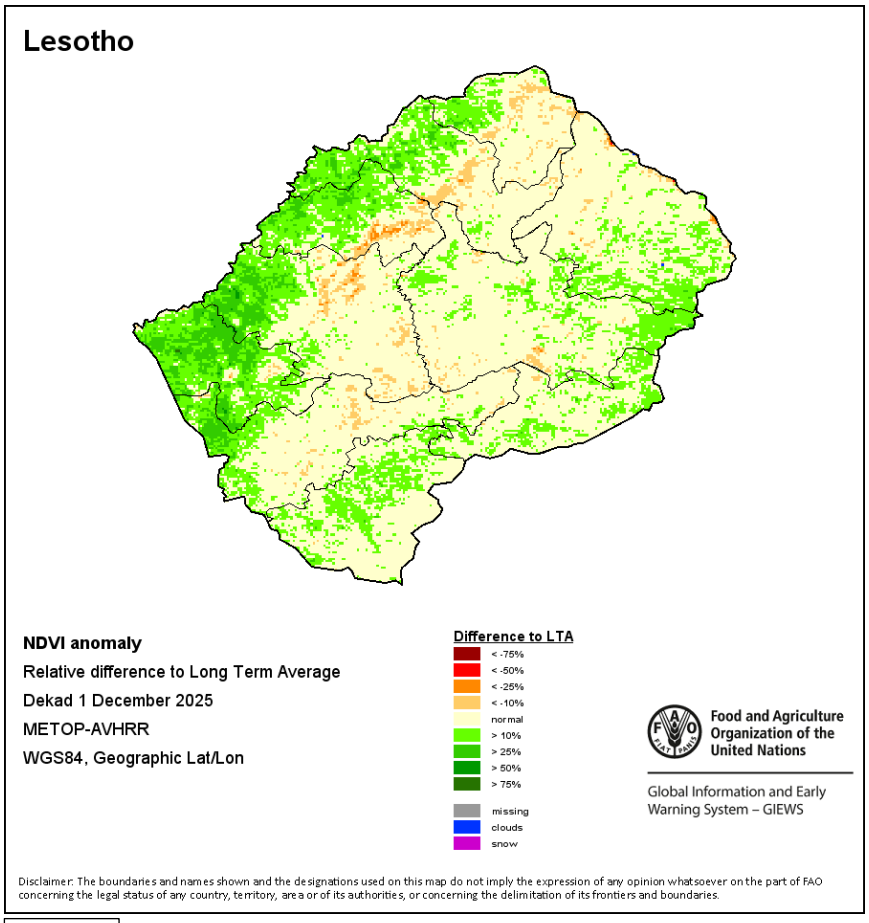

Fig. 4

<u>Weather outlook (10th to 20th DECEMBER 2025).</u>

The beginning (10 -16 Dec) of the period is anticipated to be warm to hot and dryer with isolated to scattered rain and thunderstorms, while from the 17th to the 18th chances (40%) of rain and thundershowers are expected. Chances (30%) decrease from the 19th to the 20th Dec 2025. Hail and strong winds are also anticipated. It will become mild to cool from the 14th till the end of the forecast period. Wind will be mostly light north westerly becoming moderate to strong at times.

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Seasonal Outlook (DJF 2025/26 and JFM-2026)

For the period, covering the rolling seasons from December-January-February (DJF) 2025/26, to January-February-March(JFM) 2026, above-normal rainfall conditions are expected to dominate.

N.B. It is important to note that during the summer season, flash floods, thunderstorms, hailstorms, heat waves, and strong winds are frequent and may result in the loss of lives while also posing possible damage to property and crops.

General Comments (Advisory)

OND Season

This is a critical time for land preparation and sowing in all parts of the country. Given the above predictions, farmers are strongly advised to start planting summer crops like maize, potatoes, sorghum, beans and horticultural crops; however, areas where flooding is experienced should be avoided, especially for planting crops like beans, potatoes and horticultural crops. Farmers should seek guidance from Extension officers for their specific locations on proper sowing dates as well as good management practices.

Climate Smart Agriculture:

Farmers are advised to plant early maturing varieties, use protected structures especially for horticultural crops as temperatures are expected to be warmer. Irrigation schedules for horticultural crops are recommended to support crop growth and development.

Livestock farmers are advised to keep animals under protected structures for protection against intense heat and other weather extremes (hailstorms).

Heavy rainfall

Heavy rainfall can cause waterlogging in seedbeds, nutrient leaching in prepared fields, and rapid surface runoff leading to soil erosion. Farmers should ensure that drainage systems are clear to prevent field waterlogging.

General Recommendations:

- Regular consultations with Extension officers is highly recommended
- Daily weather monitoring and use of indigenous weather forecasts is recommended for signs of significant rainfall patterns shifts

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- Water storage during heavy rainfall can be beneficial for irrigation and drinking for animals.

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